

E-commerce Rules & Policies

A customizable policy framework for an online store or multi-seller marketplace

Important: This is a general template, not legal advice. Customize it for your business model, products, payment methods, operating countries, and applicable consumer/privacy laws before publishing.

Policy Overview

Area	Core expectation
Customers	Accurate account/order information; lawful use; fair returns and payment behavior.
Sellers	Authentic products; accurate listings; legal compliance; reliable fulfillment.
Platform	Transparent terms; secure operations; fair enforcement; privacy and support processes.

1. Purpose and Scope

These Rules and Policies govern the use of [Store/Marketplace Name] (the "Platform") by customers, sellers, merchants, service providers, and other users. By accessing or using the Platform, users agree to comply with these policies, applicable laws, and any additional terms displayed during a transaction.

This document is a general operational template and should be reviewed by qualified legal counsel before publication, especially for local consumer-protection, tax, privacy, marketplace, and e-commerce requirements.

2. User Accounts and Eligibility

- Users must provide accurate, current, and complete registration and contact information.
- Users are responsible for maintaining the confidentiality of passwords, verification codes, and account credentials.
- Users must not impersonate another person, create deceptive accounts, misuse another user's account, or attempt unauthorized access.
- The Platform may suspend, restrict, or close accounts involved in fraud, abuse, repeated policy violations, chargeback abuse, or unlawful activity.
- Where age restrictions apply, users must meet the minimum legal age or use the Platform with the involvement of a parent or legal guardian.

3. Product Listings and Seller Responsibilities

- Product titles, descriptions, specifications, images, prices, stock status, warranties, and delivery estimates must be accurate and not misleading.

- Sellers must have the legal right to sell the products they list and must comply with applicable labeling, safety, tax, licensing, and consumer laws.
- Counterfeit, stolen, recalled, unsafe, illegal, or intellectual-property-infringing products are prohibited.
- Sellers must disclose material conditions such as used/refurbished status, compatibility limitations, defects, expiry dates where relevant, and important warranty exclusions.
- The Platform may remove listings, request supporting documents, limit visibility, or suspend sellers when a listing creates legal, safety, fraud, or customer-trust concerns.

4. Pricing, Discounts, Taxes, and Fees

- Displayed prices should clearly identify applicable product price, taxes, delivery charges, platform fees, and other mandatory charges before order confirmation, where required by law.
- Promotional pricing, coupons, and discounts may be subject to eligibility rules, minimum order values, expiry dates, usage limits, and exclusions.
- Obvious pricing or technical errors may be corrected. If an affected order cannot lawfully or reasonably be fulfilled, the customer should be informed and any collected amount refunded.
- Customers and sellers remain responsible for taxes or statutory charges allocated to them under applicable law.

5. Orders and Acceptance

- Submitting an order constitutes a request to purchase. An order may remain subject to payment verification, stock confirmation, fraud screening, seller acceptance, and other operational checks.
- The Platform may cancel or limit orders for suspected fraud, payment failure, inventory errors, legal restrictions, misuse of promotions, or other legitimate reasons.
- Customers should review product, quantity, address, price, and delivery details before confirming an order.

6. Payments and Payment Security

- Payments must be made using supported and lawfully authorized payment methods.
- Users must not use stolen cards, compromised payment credentials, fraudulent refunds, manipulated payment flows, or unauthorized financial instruments.
- Payment processing may be performed by third-party payment providers and may be subject to their terms and security checks.
- Where permitted, refunds are generally returned to the original payment method or another legally permitted method.

7. Shipping and Delivery

- Delivery dates and times are estimates unless expressly guaranteed. Delays may occur because of logistics, weather, customs, demand, address issues, or events outside reasonable control.
- Customers must provide a complete and serviceable delivery address and should promptly correct address errors before dispatch where possible.
- Risk of loss and title transfer will be handled according to applicable law and the specific shipping terms shown at checkout.

- Users should promptly report missing, damaged, tampered, or incorrectly delivered packages and provide reasonable evidence when requested.

8. Cancellations, Returns, Replacements, and Refunds

- Eligible cancellation windows, return periods, replacement options, and refund methods should be displayed clearly for each product category.
- Returned items may need to be unused, complete, and in original condition with accessories, serial numbers, labels, or packaging, except where consumer law provides broader rights.
- Certain items may be non-returnable for hygiene, safety, perishability, customization, digital-delivery, or other lawful reasons. Defective or incorrectly supplied goods remain subject to applicable consumer rights.
- Refund processing times may vary depending on inspection, seller confirmation, banking networks, and payment providers.
- Fraudulent return behavior, item swapping, false damage claims, or repeated abuse of refund systems may result in claim denial or account restrictions, subject to applicable law.

9. Reviews, Ratings, and User Content

- Reviews should reflect genuine experiences and must not contain fabricated claims, spam, threats, unlawful content, or undisclosed manipulation.
- Sellers must not buy, coerce, or improperly incentivize misleading positive reviews or suppress legitimate negative feedback.
- Users should avoid publishing personal data, confidential information, or content that infringes another party's rights.
- The Platform may moderate or remove content that violates these rules while preserving lawful consumer feedback.

10. Prohibited Conduct

- Fraud, scams, identity theft, phishing, money laundering, payment manipulation, and deliberate chargeback abuse are prohibited.
- Users must not scrape, overload, disrupt, reverse engineer, bypass security controls, introduce malicious code, or access non-public Platform systems without authorization.
- Harassment, threats, discriminatory abuse, deceptive communications, and misuse of customer or seller information are prohibited.
- Users must not manipulate rankings, search results, inventory, referrals, promotions, reviews, or marketplace metrics through artificial or coordinated activity.

11. Privacy and Data Protection

- Personal information should be collected and processed only for legitimate purposes described in the Platform's Privacy Policy and as permitted by applicable law.
- Reasonable administrative, technical, and organizational safeguards should be used to protect personal information.
- Users may have rights to access, correct, delete, restrict, or obtain copies of personal data depending on applicable law.

- Sellers and service providers receiving customer data must use it only for authorized transaction and service purposes and must protect it from unauthorized disclosure.

12. Intellectual Property

- Platform software, branding, layouts, text, graphics, and other protected materials may not be copied or commercially exploited without permission, except as allowed by law.
- Sellers must own or have permission to use product images, trademarks, descriptions, and other listing content.
- Rights holders may report suspected infringement through the Platform's designated complaint process.

13. Customer Support and Complaints

- Customers and sellers should use official support channels for order, payment, return, account, or safety issues.
- Complaints should include relevant order details and evidence sufficient to investigate the issue.
- The Platform should provide escalation or grievance channels where required by applicable law and should communicate material decisions in a reasonable manner.

14. Suspension, Enforcement, and Appeals

- Policy violations may result in warnings, listing removal, withheld disbursements where legally permitted, transaction limits, temporary suspension, or account termination.
- The severity of enforcement may consider the nature of the violation, risk to users, legal obligations, previous violations, and evidence of intentional abuse.
- Where appropriate or legally required, users may be given a process to appeal enforcement decisions or provide additional evidence.

15. Disclaimers and Limitation of Liability

To the maximum extent permitted by applicable law, the Platform may disclaim warranties not expressly provided and may limit liability for indirect, incidental, special, or consequential losses. Nothing in these policies excludes rights, remedies, warranties, or liabilities that cannot legally be excluded or limited.

If the Platform operates as a marketplace connecting independent sellers and buyers, the respective responsibilities of the Platform and sellers should be stated clearly in the final Terms of Service.

16. Changes to Policies

The Platform may update these policies to reflect legal, security, operational, or product changes. Material updates should be communicated as required by law. Continued use after an effective date may constitute acceptance where legally permitted.

17. Governing Law and Dispute Resolution

The final policy should specify the governing law, jurisdiction, consumer complaint mechanism, and any mediation, arbitration, or court process that applies. Mandatory consumer rights and jurisdiction rules take precedence where applicable.

18. Contact Information

Business/Platform: [Company Name]
Support Email: [support@example.com]
Registered Address: [Business Address]
Customer Support: [Phone/Help Center]
Grievance/Legal Contact: [Details if required]
Effective Date: [DD Month YYYY]
Last Updated: [DD Month YYYY]